Competitor watch · Q1 2026

Aalberts and listed peers · figures in each company's reporting currency, millions unless stated · data as of 2026-11-04

Peer comparison: listed companies

Company	Report	Revenue	Reported	Organic	Margin	Change	Margin measure
Aalberts	**Q1 2026 trading update**	**771.9 EUR**	**−0.8%**	**+2.8%**	**14.2%**	**+60 bps**	**EBITA margin**
IMI	Q1 2026 trading update	–	+6.0%	+5.0%	–		Adj. operating margin
Belimo	no report for this period						
Xylem	Q1 2026 results	2,125 USD	+2.7%	0.0%	20.6%	+20 bps	Adj. EBITDA margin
Ecolab	Q1 2026 results	4,066 USD	+10.0%	+4.0%	16.7%	+70 bps	Adj. operating margin
Watts	Q1 2026 results	677.3 USD	+21.4%	+11.9%	20.1%	+110 bps	Adj. operating margin
Emerson[1]	Q1 2026 results (quarter ended 31 Dec 2025)	4,346 USD	+4.1%	+2.0%	27.7%	−30 bps	Adj. segment EBITA margin
Pentair	Q1 2026 results	1,037 USD	+2.6%	+1.1%	25.0%	+100 bps	Adj. return on sales
Georg Fischer	no report for this period						
Danfoss[2]	no report for this period						

Organic growth by quarter

Company	Q1 2025	Q2 2025	Q3 2025	FY 2025	Q1 2026	Q2 2026	Q3 2026
Aalberts	**−3.3%**	**−3.2%**	**−1.9%**	**−2.5%**	**+2.8%**	**+5.0%**	**+13.0%**
IMI	−3.0%	+2.0%	+12.0%	+5.0%	+5.0%	+5.0%	+2.0%
Belimo	–	+20.6%	–	+23.3%	–	+29.6%	–
Xylem	+3.0%	+6.0%	+7.0%	+5.0%	0.0%	+1.0%	0.0%
Ecolab	+3.0%	+3.0%	+3.0%	+3.0%	+4.0%	+5.0%	+7.0%
Watts	−2.1%	+5.8%	+9.4%	+5.3%	+11.9%	+12.2%	due
Emerson[1]	+2.0%	+2.0%	+3.0%	+3.0%	+2.0%	+0.5%	+6.0%
Pentair	−0.8%	+1.3%	+3.3%	–	+1.1%	−17.3%	−5.0%
Georg Fischer	–	+0.1%	–	−1.7%	–	+5.7%	–
Danfoss[2]	–	−3.0%	–	+3.0%	–	+15.0%	–

Organic growth as each company defines it. Green / red = growth / decline. The outlined column is Q1 2026.

Reported margin by quarter

Company	Q1 2025	Q2 2025	Q3 2025	FY 2025	Q1 2026	Q2 2026	Q3 2026	Margin measure
Aalberts	**13.6%** **−60 bps**	**13.5%** **−150 bps**	**12.5%** **−120 bps**	**13.2%** **−180 bps**	**14.2%** **+60 bps**	**14.4%** **+90 bps**	**13.8%** **+130 bps**	**EBITA margin**
IMI	–	18.2% +30 bps	–	20.0% +30 bps	–	18.7% +50 bps	–	Adj. operating margin
Belimo	–	22.8% +320 bps	–	20.8% +159 bps	–	22.5% −30 bps	–	EBIT margin
Xylem	20.4% +120 bps	21.8% +100 bps	23.2% +200 bps	22.2% +160 bps	20.6% +20 bps	23.3% +150 bps	23.9% +70 bps	Adj. EBITDA margin
Ecolab	16.0% +190 bps	18.3% +170 bps	18.7% +110 bps	17.9% +150 bps	16.7% +70 bps	18.8% +40 bps	19.6% +70 bps	Organic operating margin
Watts	19.0%	21.6%	18.5% +140 bps	19.6% +190 bps	20.1% +110 bps	21.0% −60 bps	due	Adj. operating margin
Emerson[1]	28.0% +340 bps	28.0% +200 bps	27.1% 0 bps	27.6% +160 bps	27.7% −30 bps	27.6% −40 bps	28.5% +140 bps	Adj. segment EBITA margin
Pentair	24.0%	26.4%	25.7%	–	25.0% +100 bps	25.4% −100 bps	24.8% −90 bps	Adj. return on sales
Georg Fischer	–	10.4% −130 bps	–	11.4% −150 bps	–	13.4%	–	Comparable EBITDA margin, Flow Solutions
Danfoss[2]	–	10.6% −90 bps	–	12.9% +40 bps	–	15.3% +350 bps	–	Operational EBITA margin

Each company's own margin measure (last column), so levels are not like-for-like. Change versus the same period last year in bps; green / red = margin up / down. The outlined column is Q1 2026.

[1] Emerson's financial year ends on 30 September, so its quarters are offset from the calendar: Q1 = October–December, Q2 = January–March, Q3 = April–June, Q4 = July–September. Quarters are shown as Emerson labels them (e.g. Q1 2026 = October–December 2025). [2] Danfoss is not listed on a stock exchange (owned by the Danfoss family and the Bitten & Mads Clausen Foundation), so it has no share price; it is included because it publishes audited financial results, half-year and full-year only. For half-year reporters Q2 = H1; FY 2025 = full-year results.

Key messages: listed companies · Q1 2026

Executive summary of the main messages per company, in three clusters. Sources: each company's report for the period (see the dashboard's report library).

1. Overall performance

- **Aalberts**: revenue **771.9** EUR m (−0.8%), organic **+2.8%**, EBITA margin **14.2%** +60 bps. Growth returned in all three segments: industry +5.8% organic, semicon +2.2% (revenue +42% with acquisitions, EBITA almost doubled), building +1.3% with margin +130 bps to 14.5% despite divestments (revenue −10%).
- **IMI**: organic **+5.0%**. Organic growth across all six business lines.
- **Xylem**: revenue **2,125** USD m (+2.7%), organic **0.0%**, Adj. EBITDA margin **20.6%** +20 bps. Revenue flat organically; strength in energy metering, dewatering, transport and building solutions offset declines.
- **Ecolab**: revenue **4,066** USD m (+10.0%), organic **+4.0%**, Adj. operating margin **16.7%** +70 bps. Growth engines accelerated: High-Tech +25% organic (+131% with Ovivo), Life Sciences +11% (bioprocessing doubled), Pest +7%.
- **Watts**: revenue **677.3** USD m (+21.4%), organic **+11.9%**, Adj. operating margin **20.1%** +110 bps. Organic +11.9%: Americas +15.5% on price and data-centre volume
- **Emerson**[1]: revenue **4,346** USD m (+4.1%), organic **+2.0%**, Adj. segment EBITA margin **27.7%** −30 bps. New structure from fiscal 2026 (prior year restated).
- **Pentair**: revenue **1,037** USD m (+2.6%), organic **+1.1%**, Adj. return on sales **25.0%** +100 bps. New segment structure from 1 Jan 2026 (residential and irrigation flow moved from Flow to Water Solutions; prior year restated).

2. M&A moves

Nothing captured for this period.

3. Operations, innovation and production

Nothing captured for this period.

M&A and operations messages are captured for each company's latest report; for this period the summary shows the reported figures only.

Other key competitors · Q1 2026

Private companies and divisions, by relevance to HFC; dated public information for this period (press releases, trade press, filings).

Company (relevance)	Performance	M&A	Operations
Caleffi very high (5/5)			AHR Expo 2026 (Las Vegas, 2–4 Feb): showed contractor-driven products for North America, including the FLOWMATIC Express Coil Kit, LEGIOMIX and AngleMix mixing valves.
Reflex Winkelmann (reflexGroup) very high (5/5)			From 1 Jan 2026 Winkelmann Building+Industry became reflexGroup, bringing Reflex, Elbi and Nema under one umbrella
Spirotech high (4/5)			Launched SpiroTrap HPF, a dirt separator designed to protect heat pumps (3 Feb 2026).
Armstrong Fluid Technology moderate (3/5)	Appointed Danilo Elez as CEO (30 Mar 2026) to lead the next phase of growth; also named a new global head for data centres.		Launched the Systems Envelope Fluid Management Station (SE-FMS) (20 Jan 2026); appointed a Global Director of Offering Management and an MD for APAC & India.
ESBE moderate (3/5)			Updated Flexi circulation units (new insulation, adjustable bracket
Fernox moderate (3/5)			Exhibited at MCE 2026 Milan and CMPX 2026 (Mar 2026); launched a Renewables Product Selector for heat-pump water treatment.
Siemens Smart Infrastructure* moderate (3/5)	Fiscal Q1 2026 (Oct–Dec 2025): record orders EUR 7.2bn, revenue EUR 5.5bn, profit EUR 1.05bn (19.0% margin).		
Alfa Laval low (2/5)	Q1 2026: order intake SEK 17.6bn (+6% organic), net sales SEK 15.9bn (+2% organic), adj. EBITA margin 18.1%.		

No dated public information found for this period: Grundfos, Oventrop, ADEY, Cetetherm, Frese, Giacomini, HERZ Armaturen, PAW, PEWO Energietechnik, Wessels Company, Wilo, Zilmet, Resideo (Honeywell Home), Victaulic.

* Siemens Smart Infrastructure: Siemens' fiscal year ends 30 September; quarters are shown as Siemens labels them (Q1 = October–December).